Retell: The Laboratory

Day 3 · Retell

What to do: Student A retells steps 1–4, student B steps 5–8. Then swap the roles.

In the book
4000 Essential English Words 1, Unit 2, **“The Laboratory”**, page 18 (the story) · page 19 (questions).
Read it once (5 minutes), close the book, then retell with the map below.

#	Say	Words to use
1	What did Mia’s father have? What did he do with the door?	laboratory · lock · secret · project
2	What did Mia do one night?	approach · door · experiment
3	What did she hear?	suddenly · loud · evil laugh · noise
4	How did she feel? What did she do?	scare · walk quickly · room
5	Who came next night? What did she say?	Liz · adventure · terrible
6	How did the girls go in?	nervous · dinner · stairs · carefully
7	What did they smell and hear?	chemicals · worse · monster · shout
8	What was the secret?	doll · laughed · father · funny

★ Tell it in the past simple (add to your retelling)

1. What did Mia hear? What didn’t she do? (door · laugh · open)
2. Did the girls go into the laboratory alone? Who didn’t see them? (father · dinner)
3. What did her father show them in the end? (doll · laugh)

Three ways to retell

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What to do: Rounds 1 to 3 take about 15 minutes. Then the speaking questions.

1 Round 1: with the story map

Retell the whole story to your partner. The listener ticks the words they hear.

- [ ] adventure
- [ ] approach
- [ ] carefully
- [ ] chemical
- [ ] create
- [ ] evil
- [ ] experiment
- [ ] kill
- [ ] laboratory
- [ ] laugh
- [ ] loud
- [ ] nervous
- [ ] noise
- [ ] project
- [ ] scare
- [ ] secret
- [ ] shout
- [ ] smell
- [ ] terrible
- [ ] worse

2 Round 2: change the narrator

Retell it as **Mia**, **Liz** or **the father**. Use "I": *"I locked the door, because I didn't want..."*

3 Round 3: change the ending

The doll does not laugh. Something else is in the laboratory. What did the girls find? Invent a new ending (3–4 sentences).

4 Listener's check

- [ ] 5+ Unit 2 words
- [ ] past simple, positive and negative
- [ ] a clear order
- [ ] one new idea

5 Warm-up: irregular verbs, set 1 (say the past)

go	see	have	make
get	buy	eat	take
come	give		

went · saw · had · made · got · bought · ate · took · came · gave